MODULE 8

Time to Grow!

"The secret garden bloomed and bloomed and every morning revealed new miracles."

— FRANCES HODGSON BURNETT

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What do plants need to live and grow?

MAIN STORIES

1	**Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow** · Nadia Higgins	INFORMATIONAL
2	**Jack and the Beanstalk** · Helen Lester	FAIRY TALE
3	**Jackie and the Beanstalk** · Lori Mortensen	FAIRY TALE
4	**Don't Touch Me!** · Elizabeth Preston	INFORMATIONAL

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NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 8 · Time to Grow! · Grade 2 · 27 Items

CCSS L.2.4 · L.2.5 · L.2.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.2.6

fertilize

When you **fertilize** soil, you —

- ○ **A.** take all the minerals out of the soil.
- ○ **B.** dig the soil up and throw it away.
- ○ **C.** pack the soil down hard so nothing can grow.
- ○ **D.** add something that helps plants grow.

Q2 L.2.6

germinate

Seeds **germinate** when they —

- ○ **A.** dry out and stop growing.
- ○ **B.** get harder and stay shut.
- ○ **C.** begin to grow.
- ○ **D.** sink down deeper into the soil.

Q3 L.2.6

survive

When things **survive**, they —

- ○ **A.** stay alive.
- ○ **B.** wither and die.
- ○ **C.** stop growing for good.
- ○ **D.** get sick and weak.

POWER WORDS · EXPERIMENT WITH WHAT A PLANT NEEDS TO GROW

Q4 L.2.4

minerals

"They need **minerals** to stay healthy." **Minerals** are —

- ○ **A.** tiny seeds that grow into new plants.
- ○ **B.** little pieces from the earth that help living things stay healthy.
- ○ **C.** tiny bugs that live in the dirt.
- ○ **D.** drops of water in the soil.

Q5 L.2.5 TRAP

process

"Photosynthesis is a **process** in which green leaves make food." Here, **process** means —

- ○ **A.** a single moment.
- ○ **B.** a parade in a town.
- ○ **C.** a long line at the store.
- ○ **D.** a set of steps that happen in order to make something.

Q6 L.2.4

fuels

"Sunlight **fuels** photosynthesis." Here, **fuels** means —

- ○ **A.** gives the energy that makes something work.
- ○ **B.** takes the energy away so it stops.
- ○ **C.** slows something down little by little.
- ○ **D.** blocks the sunlight from a leaf.

POWER WORDS · EXPERIMENT WITH WHAT A PLANT NEEDS TO GROW (CONTINUED)

Q7 L.2.4

provides

The soil **provides** minerals that most plants need. Here, **provides** means —

- ○ **A.** takes away from.
- ○ **B.** keeps for itself.
- ○ **C.** gives what is needed.
- ○ **D.** uses something up.

Q8 L.2.4

sprout

"Water softens the coat, so the seed can **sprout**." To **sprout** is to —

- **A.** stay shut inside its hard coat.
- **B.** begin to grow out of a seed.
- **C.** dry out and die.
- **D.** rot away in the wet soil.

Q9 L.2.5 TRAP

moisten

"**Moisten** the second bowl's cotton balls all the way through." To **moisten** is to —

- **A.** make a little bit wet.
- **B.** burn with heat.
- **C.** freeze into ice.
- **D.** moan or cry softly.

Q10 L.2.4

seedling

"Give the **seedling** water and sun." A **seedling** is —

- **A.** a very old, tall tree.
- **B.** a dry seed still in its packet.
- **C.** a full-grown plant with flowers.
- **D.** a young plant that has just begun to grow.

Q11 L.2.5 TRAP

spiky

A cactus is **spiky**. Here, **spiky** means —

- **A.** very soft and smooth.
- **B.** a popular drink.
- **C.** covered with sharp points.
- **D.** smooth and rounded like a stone.

Q12 L.2.5 TRAP

swipe

"Jack looked left and right, and—SWIPE!—down the beanstalk he went with his treasure." Here, **swipe** means —

- **A.** a slow, gentle walk.
- **B.** a quick grab or sweep.
- **C.** a credit card payment at a store.
- **D.** a careful, gentle pat.

Q13 L.2.4

whacked

"Jack grabbed an ax, **whacked** the beanstalk, and SPLAT." **Whacked** means —

- **A.** hit it hard.
- **B.** tapped it softly.
- **C.** shook it a little.
- **D.** brushed past it.

Q14 L.2.4

whimpered

When the cow was sad, she **whimpered**. **Whimpered** means —

- **A.** shouted with joy.
- **B.** laughed out loud.
- **C.** roared loudly and angrily.
- **D.** made a low, soft, sad cry.

Q15 L.2.5 TRAP

plenty

"They had **plenty** to eat and lived happily ever after." **Plenty** means —

- **A.** a tiny amount, not enough.
- **B.** a large amount — more than enough.
- **C.** nothing at all.
- **D.** a flat, open field ("plain").

POWER WORDS · JACKIE AND THE BEANSTALK

Q16 L.2.4

adorable

"It was a cute little calf — **adorable**." **Adorable** means —

- **A.** dirty and ugly.
- **B.** scary and mean.
- **C.** very cute and lovable.
- **D.** plain and boring.

POWER WORDS · JACKIE AND THE BEANSTALK (CONTINUED)

Q17 L.2.4

oversized

"...they lived with a GIGANTIC cow." A cow this big is **oversized**. **Oversized** means —

- **A.** much bigger than usual.
- **B.** much smaller than usual.
- **C.** exactly the right size.
- **D.** thin and very light.

Q18 L.2.4

hauling

Jackie was **hauling** the cow down the street. To **haul** is to —

- **A.** lift something light with one hand.
- **B.** push it gently with one finger.
- **C.** let something roll away on its own.
- **D.** pull or carry something heavy.

Q19 L.2.5 TRAP

glanced

Jackie **glanced** at the mysterious woman. Here, **glanced** means —

- **A.** hit her with the shoulder ("glanced off").
- **B.** took a quick look.
- **C.** stared for a long, long time.
- **D.** closed her eyes tight.

POWER WORDS · DON'T TOUCH ME!

Q20 L.2.4

sharp

"Roses have **sharp** prickles on their stems." **Sharp** means —

- ○ **A.** soft like a pillow.
- ○ **B.** smooth and rounded at the end.
- ○ **C.** coming to a fine point that can cut or poke.
- ○ **D.** bendy and floppy.

Q21 L.2.4

prickles

A rose stem has **prickles**. **Prickles** are —

- ○ **A.** small sharp points that grow on a plant.
- ○ **B.** soft round petals.
- ○ **C.** smooth green leaves.
- ○ **D.** sweet-smelling flowers.

POWER WORDS · DON'T TOUCH ME! (CONTINUED)

Q22 L.2.4

thorns

"Acacia trees have big, scary **thorns**." **Thorns** are —

- ○ **A.** long soft hairs.
- ○ **B.** soft green buds.
- ○ **C.** the seeds of the tree.
- ○ **D.** sharp, woody points that grow from a stem or branch.

Q23 L.2.5 TRAP

extra

"For **extra** protection, the acacia uses ants." Here, **extra** means —

- ○ **A.** a person who walks past in a movie scene.
- ○ **B.** more than the usual amount — added on.
- ○ **C.** just the usual amount, nothing added.
- ○ **D.** almost none.

Q24 L.2.4

poke

A cactus spine can **poke** you. To **poke** means —

- ○ **A.** press or jab with a sharp point.
- ○ **B.** pat softly with a flat hand.
- ○ **C.** rub gently back and forth.
- ○ **D.** stroke smoothly with one finger.

Q25 L.2.5 TRAP

nasty

Touch the wrong plant and "you might get a **nasty** rash." Here, **nasty** means —

- ○ **A.** sweet and pleasant.
- ○ **B.** shaped like a knot ("knotty").
- ○ **C.** harmful and unpleasant.
- ○ **D.** kind and gentle.

Q26 L.2.4

sensitive

"The **sensitive** plant folds up its leaves when you touch it." **Sensitive** means —

- ○ **A.** slow to notice anything at all.
- ○ **B.** quick to feel and react to a touch or feeling.
- ○ **C.** not able to feel a touch.
- ○ **D.** tough and hard to hurt.

Q27 L.2.5 TRAP

attack

"The ants **attack** and sting." Here, **attack** means —

- ○ **A.** stick something onto a page ("attach").
- ○ **B.** sit very still in one place.
- ○ **C.** rush at someone or something to hurt or stop them.
- ○ **D.** run away to hide.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 8 · Time to Grow! · Grade 2

CCSS RL.2.1 – RL.2.7 / RI.2.1 – RI.2.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

Story 1 · Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · NADIA HIGGINS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.2.1

According to the text, what do plants need to live?

- ○ **A.** Only sunlight.
- ○ **B.** Air, water, sunlight, and minerals.
- ○ **C.** Sugar and salt only.
- ○ **D.** Nothing — they grow on their own.

Q2 RI.2.8

The text tells the reader to take a picture of the plant on the first day. What reason does the author give to support this step?

- ○ **A.** So you can sell the picture to a magazine.
- ○ **B.** So the plant will know it is being watched.
- ○ **C.** So you can compare how the plant looked at the start to how it looks later and see how it changed.
- ○ **D.** So the camera flash will help the plant grow faster.

Q3 RI.2.3

What is the FIRST step of the seed experiment?

- ○ **A.** Place a fan next to the bowls.
- ○ **B.** Fill every bowl with soil.
- ○ **C.** Put two cotton balls in each bowl.
- ○ **D.** Put the seeds in the freezer.

Q4 RI.2.3

According to the text, what happens to a seed when water touches it?

- **A.** The seed dries up immediately.
- **B.** The seed turns into a rock.
- **C.** The seed flies away.
- **D.** The seed coat softens so the seed can sprout.

Q5 RI.2.3

In the leaf experiment, what happened to the leaves that were covered in petroleum jelly?

- **A.** They started to wilt because they could not let air in and out.
- **B.** They grew twice as fast.
- **C.** They changed color to blue.
- **D.** They fell off and grew into new plants.

Q6 RI.2.5

"Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow" is informational text. What makes it informational?

- **A.** It tells a made-up story with talking plants.
- **B.** It gives real facts and steps about how something works in the real world.
- **C.** It is a long poem about gardens.
- **D.** It is a song about flowers.

Q7 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did the author write "Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow"?

- **A.** To tell a funny story about a talking plant.
- **B.** To sell bowls and cotton balls to readers.
- **C.** To explain why gardens look pretty.
- **D.** To teach the reader what plants need and to show them how to find out by doing experiments.

Q8 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow"?

- **A.** Only sunlight matters — green leaves make food from light alone.
- **B.** Soil is enough by itself; water and air are not really needed.
- **C.** Plants need air, water, sunlight, and minerals — experiments prove it.
- **D.** The book mainly tells the story of one sunflower that grew tall in a week.

Story 2 · Jack and the Beanstalk

FAIRY TALE · HELEN LESTER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.2.1

Where did Jack live at the start of the story?

- **A.** In a giant castle.
- **B.** In a poor little hut with his mother.
- **C.** Inside a tall beanstalk.
- **D.** In a city apartment.

Q10 RL.2.3

What did Jack bring home instead of money?

- **A.** A bag of gold coins.
- **B.** The cow, Moozetta.
- **C.** A handful of beans he held like a treasure.
- **D.** A baby goose.

Q11 RL.2.3

What did Jack do to make the beans grow?

- **A.** He planted them in a sunny spot and watered them.
- **B.** He put them under his bed.
- **C.** He fed them to the cow.
- **D.** He sang to them all night.

Q12 RL.2.3

How did Jack get DOWN the beanstalk with the giant's treasure?

- **A.** He flew on a parrot.
- **B.** He waited for the giant to drop him.
- **C.** He took the elevator.
- **D.** He swiped down the beanstalk — quick and sneaky.

Q13 RL.2.3

What did Jack do to the beanstalk after he came down with the treasure?

- ○ **A.** He whacked it with an ax — and it fell with a SPLAT.
- ○ **B.** He climbed it again at once.
- ○ **C.** He gave it more water.
- ○ **D.** He planted another seed next to it.

Q14 RL.2.3

After the beanstalk fell, what did Jack do for the giant?

- ○ **A.** Jack ran away forever.
- ○ **B.** Jack helped the giant — he showed him how to grow his own beanstalk.
- ○ **C.** Jack hid in the hut and never came out.
- ○ **D.** Jack ate all the giant's food.

Q15 RL.2.5

"Jack and the Beanstalk" is a fairy tale. What makes it a fairy tale?

- ○ **A.** It is a list of plant facts.
- ○ **B.** It is a recipe for soup.
- ○ **C.** It starts "Once upon a time" and has magical things (beans grow into a giant beanstalk overnight).
- ○ **D.** It teaches you to count to ten.

Q16 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Jack and the Beanstalk"?

- ○ **A.** Jack takes the giant's treasure and never goes back or shares anything.
- ○ **B.** Trading the cow Moozetta for a handful of beans was a mistake that ruined the family.
- ○ **C.** The story shows that climbing tall plants is the best way to find treasure.
- ○ **D.** A small seed, planted with care, can change everything — and helping others (the giant) brings plenty for all.

Story 3 · Jackie and the Beanstalk

FAIRY TALE · LORI MORTENSEN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.2.1

Where did Jackie and her father live?

- **A.** In a barn.
- **B.** In a crowded apartment — with a GIGANTIC cow.
- **C.** In a giant's castle.
- **D.** In a tent in the woods.

Q18 RL.2.3

Why was buying the cow a "stupendously bad idea"?

- **A.** Cute calves grow into oversized cows that don't fit in apartments.
- **B.** The cow could not give milk.
- **C.** The cow was a robot.
- **D.** Jackie hated cows.

Q19 RL.2.3

What did the mysterious woman give Jackie in exchange for the cow?

- **A.** A bag of gold.
- **B.** A small radio.
- **C.** Some special beans.
- **D.** A new apartment key.

Q20 RL.2.3

What did Jackie need to DO to grow the beanstalk?

- **A.** Keep the beans dry in a closet.
- **B.** Throw them out the window.
- **C.** Boil them for soup.
- **D.** Plant the beans in dirt, add water, and wait until morning.

Q21 RL.2.3

Who was Mr. Fefifofum?

- **A.** A real, magic giant in the clouds.
- **B.** An upstairs neighbor who was AS big and loud AS a giant.
- **C.** Jackie's grandfather.
- **D.** A cow that could talk.

Q22 RL.2.3

What did Jackie do when she realized she had borrowed the harp without asking?

- **A.** She gave it back, apologized, and explained.
- **B.** She kept it secret forever.
- **C.** She sold it.
- **D.** She broke it on purpose.

Q23 RL.2.9

How is "Jackie and the Beanstalk" DIFFERENT from "Jack and the Beanstalk"?

- **A.** Jackie's beans never grow.
- **B.** There is no cow in Jackie's story.
- **C.** Jackie is a boy and Jack is a girl.
- **D.** Jackie lives in an apartment, "the giant" is a loud neighbor, and Jackie returns the harp instead of keeping it.

Q24 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Jackie and the Beanstalk"?

- **A.** Jackie keeps the harp for herself and never tells Mr. Fefifofum where it went.
- **B.** Mr. Fefifofum is a real giant who chases Jackie all the way down the beanstalk.
- **C.** A modern Jackie can grow a beanstalk too — and when you do wrong, return it, apologize, explain.
- **D.** Buying the GIGANTIC cow turned out to be the family's smartest decision in the end.

Story 4 · Don't Touch Me!

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · ELIZABETH PRESTON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RI.2.2

According to the text, why do some plants need defenses?

- **A.** Because they can't run away from hungry animals — so they fight back.
- **B.** Because they want to be tall.
- **C.** Because they like to look pretty.
- **D.** Because the rain hurts them.

Q26 RI.2.3

What does a rose use as a defense?

- **A.** A loud song.
- **B.** A wide leaf umbrella.
- **C.** Sharp prickles on its stems.
- **D.** A bowl of poison.

Q27 RI.2.3

According to the text, what is special about holly leaves and berries?

- **A.** They are extra sweet.
- **B.** They have sharp points AND they are poisonous — extra protection.
- **C.** They glow in the dark.
- **D.** They are made of plastic.

Q28 RI.2.5

How does the author organize "Don't Touch Me!"?

- **A.** As a step-by-step recipe for cooking plants.
- **B.** As a long story about one rose bush from start to end.
- **C.** As a list of problems and one big solution at the end.
- **D.** By giving example after example of different plants and the defenses each one uses.

Q29 RI.2.3

What is special about the sensitive (touch-me-not) plant?

- **A.** It quickly folds up its leaves when touched.
- **B.** It stabs you with thorns.
- **C.** It runs away on tiny legs.
- **D.** It changes into a butterfly.

Q30 RI.2.3

How does the acacia tree get EXTRA protection?

- **A.** It calls a farmer.
- **B.** It uses ants that attack and sting hungry animals.
- **C.** It shoots water.
- **D.** It hides underground.

Q31 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did Elizabeth Preston write "Don't Touch Me!"?

- **A.** To warn readers that every plant is poisonous and should never be touched.
- **B.** To explain step by step how to grow roses, cactuses, and holly in a home garden.
- **C.** To teach readers the surprising defenses plants use to survive.
- **D.** To tell a single long story about one acacia tree and the ants that live inside it.

Q32 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Don't Touch Me!"?

- **A.** Plants stay safe from hungry animals by quickly running away when one comes close.
- **B.** Only roses and cactus plants have any real way to defend themselves from animals.
- **C.** Poison ivy is the most dangerous plant of all and is the main focus of the whole text.
- **D.** Plants can't run, but many defenses — prickles, thorns, poisons, sensitive leaves, ant helpers — keep them safe.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 8 · Time to Grow! · Grade 2

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about how living things grow. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Function DOK 3

In **"Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow,"** a plant needs FOUR things: air, water, sunlight, and minerals. Show what happens when ONE thing is missing — and what happens when all four are there.

PLANT NEEDS · ONE MISSING & ALL FOUR

MISSING ONE NEED	→	ALL FOUR NEEDS ARE THERE

Which need is the EASIEST to forget? Why does that one matter?

_____

Q2 Change DOK 2

In **"Experiment with What a Plant Needs to Grow"** and "The Growth of a Sunflower," a seed CHANGES into a blooming plant in steps. Make a 3-step life cycle in your OWN words.

SEED TO BLOOM · 3-STEP LIFE CYCLE

STEP 1 · SEED · GERMINATE	STEP 2 · SEEDLING · GROW	STEP 3 · BLOOM

Which step do you think is the HARDEST for the plant? Why?

Q3 Connection DOK 3

Compare **"Jack and the Beanstalk"** and **"Jackie and the Beanstalk."** Both use a beanstalk — but the two stories make DIFFERENT choices. Map them.

TWO BEANSTALKS · SAME SEED, DIFFERENT STORY



JACK · SETTING / HELPER	JACKIE · SETTING / HELPER
JACK · WHAT HE KEEPS	JACKIE · WHAT SHE RETURNS

Which CHOICE makes Jackie's story feel more right to you? Why?

Q4 Form DOK 3

In **"Don't Touch Me!,"** plants have three KINDS of defense. Trace one example of EACH kind — and how it helps the plant survive.

THREE KINDS OF PLANT DEFENSE

SHARP · PRICKLES OR THORNS

which plant? how does it hurt?

CHEMICAL · POISONS OR ITCH

which plant? what happens?

HELPER · FOLDING OR ANTS

which plant? who helps?

Which defense surprised you the MOST? Why?

Q5 Reflection DOK 4

Essential Question: What do plants need to live and grow? Use ideas from TWO of the texts in this module to answer.

TWO-TEXT SYNTHESIS

TEXT 1 · TITLE & AUTHOR

What does this text show a plant needs — or how a plant protects what it needs?

TEXT 2 · TITLE & AUTHOR

What does this text show a plant needs — or how a plant protects what it needs?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 8 · Time to Grow! · Grade 2

MAP RIT 180 → 200 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Bean in the Cup

Mina had a small paper cup. Her teacher gave her one bean. "Plant it," the teacher said. Mina put dirt in the cup. She pushed the bean down with her finger. She gave it one drop of water. She set the cup on the windowsill. Every morning, she looked. For three days, nothing happened. On the fourth day, Mina saw a tiny green tip. It looked like a baby leaf. "It germinated!" she said. By the end of the week, the seedling was tall. It had two small leaves. Mina was happy. She gave it more water and more sun. She had learned what a tiny bean needs to grow.

120 WORDS · LEXILE 240–290L · RIT 180–189

Q1 RIT 180 | Lexile 240L | Key Detail

What did Mina's teacher give her?

- ○ **A.** One bean.
- ○ **B.** A jar of water.
- ○ **C.** A bag of soil.
- ○ **D.** A handful of seeds.

Q2 RIT 184 | Lexile 250L | Cause & Effect

Why did Mina put the cup on the windowsill?

- ○ **A.** So no one would see it.
- ○ **B.** So the bean would freeze.
- ○ **C.** So the bean would get sun — sunlight helps a plant grow.
- ○ **D.** Because the teacher told her to throw it out.

Q3 RIT 186 Lexile 260L Inference

Why did Mina see "nothing" for three days?

- ○ **A.** The bean was broken.
- ○ **B.** The change was happening UNDER the dirt — the seed was germinating where she could not see it.
- ○ **C.** She forgot to water it every day.
- ○ **D.** The teacher took it home.

Q4 RIT 188 Lexile 270L Vocabulary

In the passage, "It germinated!" most likely means —

- ○ **A.** It changed color.
- ○ **B.** It broke open and died.
- ○ **C.** It rolled out of the cup.
- ○ **D.** It began to grow.

Q5 RIT 189 Lexile 290L Main Idea

What did Mina LEARN from her bean?

- ○ **A.** A bean does not need anything to grow.
- ○ **B.** Only farmers can grow beans.
- ○ **C.** A tiny bean needs dirt, water, and sun to germinate and grow into a seedling.
- ○ **D.** Beans grow only in summer.

Passage 2 · The Cactus and the Boy

Tomas lived in a hot, dry place. In his yard, he had a big cactus. It was tall and green. Its sides were covered with sharp spines. One day, his little sister ran near it. "Don't touch!" Tomas called. "It can poke you." His sister stopped. "Why does the plant have spines?" she asked. "Because it lives where animals are hungry," Tomas said. "The spines keep deer and goats away. The cactus also stores water inside. The spines protect that water." His sister looked closer, but she did not touch. She saw that the spines were sharp and silver in the sun. "Smart plant," she said. Tomas smiled. The cactus could not run. But it had everything it needed to survive — even in a dry place.

132 WORDS · LEXILE 300–350L · RIT 190–195

Q6 RIT 190 | Lexile 300L | Key Detail

Where did Tomas live?

- **A.** In a cold, snowy place.
- **B.** In a hot, dry place.
- **C.** In a wet forest.
- **D.** On a boat.

Q7 RIT 192 | Lexile 320L | Cause & Effect

According to Tomas, why does the cactus have spines?

- **A.** So it can dance in the wind.
- **B.** Because the gardener wanted them.
- **C.** So that birds can sit on them.
- **D.** To keep hungry animals away and to protect the water stored inside.

Q8 RIT 193 | Lexile 330L | Vocabulary

In the passage, "It can poke you" most likely means —

- **A.** It can press into your skin with a sharp point.
- **B.** It can sing to you.
- **C.** It can talk to you.
- **D.** It can give you a flower.

Q9 RIT 194 | Lexile 340L | Inference

Why does the cactus STORE water inside?

- **A.** Because it is heavy.
- **B.** Because it likes the rain.
- **C.** Because it lives in a dry place — it needs to keep water for the dry days.
- **D.** Because Tomas told it to.

Q10 RIT 195 | Lexile 350L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Cactus and the Boy"?

- **A.** Cactuses are dangerous and should be cut down.
- **B.** A plant can't run, but a smart plant — like the cactus — has spines AND stored water to survive in a hard place.
- **C.** Sisters should never go in the yard.
- **D.** Plants in deserts always die.

Passage 3 · The Tomato That Almost Died

Ji-ho was eight when his grandfather gave him a tomato seedling. It was small and green. "Take care of it," Grandfather said. "It needs four things — sunlight, water, air, and good soil." Ji-ho put the pot on the porch. He watered it every morning. But one weekend, he forgot. The next Monday, the seedling drooped. Its leaves were yellow. Ji-ho almost cried. He carried the pot to his grandfather. "I think it's dying," Ji-ho said. Grandfather touched the soil. It was bone dry. "It needs water — right now," Grandfather said. "It also needs you to fertilize the soil. Then the soil can provide minerals." Together, they watered it slowly and added a little fertilizer. Ji-ho waited. He went back the next day. The leaves looked greener. Three days later, the seedling stood tall again. Ji-ho learned that growing a plant means showing up — every day, even on weekends.

149 WORDS · LEXILE 360–410L · RIT 195–199

Q11 RIT 195 · Lexile 360L · Key Detail

What did Ji-ho's grandfather give him?

- ○ **A.** A bag of seeds.
- ○ **B.** A cactus.
- ○ **C.** A pot of soil.
- ○ **D.** A tomato seedling.

Q12 RIT 196 · Lexile 370L · Cause & Effect

Why did the seedling DROOP on Monday?

- ○ **A.** Ji-ho forgot to water it over the weekend — the soil dried out.
- ○ **B.** It was tired from growing too fast.
- ○ **C.** The grandfather hid it.
- ○ **D.** A bug ate the leaves.

Q13 RIT 197 · Lexile 380L · Vocabulary

In the passage, "fertilize the soil" most likely means —

- ○ **A.** Wash the soil with hot water.
- ○ **B.** Put the soil in a freezer.
- ○ **C.** Add something to the soil that helps plants grow.
- ○ **D.** Throw the soil away.

Q14 RIT 198 Lexile 390L Inference

Why did the seedling RECOVER three days later?

- **A.** Because the porch was painted green.
- **B.** Because Ji-ho and his grandfather gave it the water and minerals it needed.
- **C.** Because plants always recover on their own.
- **D.** Because the wind stopped.

Q15 RIT 199 Lexile 410L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Tomato That Almost Died"?

- **A.** Plants need their four things every day — and a grower has to show up, not just once, but again and again.
- **B.** Growing a plant is easy — you can forget it for a week.
- **C.** Tomatoes are the only plants worth growing.
- **D.** Grandfathers always know best.

Passage 4 · The Forest That Cleans the Air

A forest is more than just trees. It is a whole living system. Each tree pulls air in through its green leaves. The leaves take in a gas called carbon dioxide. In a process called photosynthesis, the leaves use sunlight, water, and air to make food for the tree. While the leaves make food, they breathe out a clean gas called oxygen. People and animals need oxygen to breathe. So a forest is like a giant green factory that gives oxygen for free. Big trees pull up water from the soil with their roots. The water carries minerals up into every leaf. When rain falls, the forest holds it. The wide leaves slow the rain. The deep roots drink it. Without forests, the soil would wash away. Without forests, the air would not stay clean. We need plants — and the biggest plants of all are trees.

150 WORDS · LEXILE 440–500L · RIT 199–200

Q16 RIT 199 Lexile 440L Key Detail

According to the passage, what gas do leaves take in?

- **A.** Pure water.
- **B.** Salt air.
- **C.** Pure sunlight.
- **D.** Carbon dioxide.

Q17 RIT 200 | Lexile 460L | Cause & Effect

Why is the forest like a "giant green factory"?

- **A.** Because it MAKES oxygen for us as a side effect of feeding the tree.
- **B.** Because it has machines inside.
- **C.** Because people work there.
- **D.** Because it smells like a factory.

Q18 RIT 200 | Lexile 480L | Vocabulary

"In a PROCESS called photosynthesis..." Here, "process" most likely means —

- **A.** A single moment.
- **B.** A set of steps that happen in order to make something.
- **C.** A parade.
- **D.** A line at the store.

Q19 RIT 200 | Lexile 490L | Inference

Why does the passage say "without forests, the soil would wash away"?

- **A.** Because trees drink all the soil.
- **B.** Because soil floats.
- **C.** Because trees turn soil into water.
- **D.** Because tree roots and leaves slow the rain and hold the soil in place.

Q20 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Forest That Cleans the Air"?

- **A.** Forests are only good for wood.
- **B.** Trees just stand still and do nothing.
- **C.** Forests are living systems that need the same things small plants need — and in return, they clean our air, hold our soil, and keep our world alive.
- **D.** Only animals matter, not plants.